

Absolutely — **much** is another excellent **grammar/polyfunctionality** target. In your passage it appears in:

> “he became **much more lively** than people expected.”

Here **much** does **not** mean 「很多」. It strengthens a comparative:

> **much more lively** = 生動活潑得多

So this is a perfect example of why **much** deserves its own entry even though **more** has already been curated.

Word family: **much**

Base word: much

Comparative/superlative relationship: much → more → most

Part of speech / function: determiner (限定詞) / pronoun (代名詞) / adverb (副詞) / degree modifier (程度修飾語)

Much has essentially no useful derivational family of its own. Its richness comes from its grammatical functions and constructions.

Meaning in your passage: **much + comparative** (比較級) —得多 ; 大大更加.....

Your sentence:

> “Once he started teaching, he became **much more lively** than people expected.”

Here:

> **much** intensifies **more lively**.

It tells us that the difference was **large**, not slight.

繁體中文 :

用來加強比較級，表示兩者之間的程度差距很大；得多 / 大大更.....

Natural translation:

> “He became much more lively than people expected.”

「他開始上課後，變得**比大家預期中生動活潑得多**。」

So:

> **much more lively**

= **生動得多 / 活潑得多**

1. **much + comparative adjective/adverb (比較程度) —得多 ; 更加.....很多**

This is your exact source use.

Practice 1 — Original

> “He became **much more lively** than people expected.”

「他變得**比大家預期中生動活潑得多**。」

Practice 2

> “The second explanation was **much clearer**.”

「第二個解釋**清楚得多**。」

Practice 3

> “She answered the question **much more confidently** this time.”

「她這次回答問題時**自信得多**。」

much + comparative = 強調比較差距很大，而不是只稍微有差別

Common:

* much better

* much worse

* much easier

* much harder

* much more useful

* much less expensive

2. **much + uncountable noun (不可數名詞) — 很多 ; 大量**

This is the basic quantity use.

Practice 4

> “We don’t have ****much time****.”

「我們沒有****很多時間****。」

Practice 5

> “How ****much information**** do we need?”

「我們需要****多少資料****？」

****much + uncountable noun = 表示不可數事物具有大量 / 某一數量****

Common:

- * much time
- * much money
- * much information
- * much work
- * much progress

3. ****much = a large amount (代名詞) — 很多 ; 大量****

Here ****much**** stands alone.

Practice 6

> “There isn’t ****much**** left to discuss.”

「已經沒有****多少內容****需要討論了。」

Practice 7

> “I learned ****much**** from him.”

「我從他身上學到了****很多****。」

****much — pronoun = 代替前文已知的不可數事物 / 內容 , 表示大量****

Important register note:

> “I learned much from him.”

is grammatical but somewhat formal.

In everyday English:

> “I learned **a lot** from him.”

is more natural.

4. **much + verb** (程度) — 很 ; 非常 ; 在很大程度上

Especially common in negatives, questions, and certain formal structures.

Practice 8

> “I don’t **much like** memorising facts.”

「我**不太喜歡**背資料。」

Practice 9

> “The situation has **much improved**.”

「情況已經**大大改善**。」

much + verb = 表示某個行為、感受或變化達到很高程度

But this pattern has register restrictions.

5. **very much + verb** (程度) — 非常 ; 很

This is far more common than bare **much** in affirmative everyday English.

Practice 10

> “I **very much enjoyed** his lessons.”

「我**非常喜歡**他的課堂。」

Practice 11

> “I **very much appreciate** your help.”

「我**非常感激**你的幫助。」

very much + verb = 大幅加強喜歡、欣賞、希望、感謝等感受 / 態度的程度

Also:

> “Thank you very much.”

= 「非常感謝你。」

6. **not much + noun/pronoun (數量少) — 不多 ; 沒有多少**

Practice 12

> “There wasn’t **much homework** that week.”

「那星期的功課**不多**。」

Practice 13

> “Not **much** has changed.”

「沒有**太多**改變。」

not much = 某種不可數數量或程度很少

This is extremely common because **much** naturally occurs in negatives.

7. **how much + uncountable noun (詢問數量) — 多少.....**

Practice 14

> “How **much time** do we have?”

「我們有**多少時間**？」

Practice 15

> “How **much money** did the school spend?”

「學校花了**多少錢**？」

****how much = 詢問不可數事物的數量 / 程度****

8. ****how much? (價格) — 多少錢? ****

A very common specialized conversational use.

Practice 16

> “How ****much**** is this book?”

「這本書****多少錢****? 」

Practice 17

> “How much did the glasses cost?”

「那副眼鏡****多少錢 / 花了多少錢****? 」

****how much = 詢問價格或金額****

This grows from the quantity meaning.

9. ****too much + uncountable noun (過量) — 太多.....****

You already curated this under ****too****, but it is also a core construction of ****much****.

Practice 18

> “There was ****too much information**** on the slide.”

「投影片上有****太多資料****。」

Practice 19

> “He spent ****too much time**** memorising dates.”

「他花了****太多時間****背年份。」

****too much = 不可數數量超過合理、需要或適當程度****

10. **too much (單獨使用) — 太多 ; 令人吃不消**

Practice 20

> “The pressure became **too much**.”

「壓力變得**令人吃不消**。」

Practice 21

> “Three exams in one day would be **too much**.”

「一天考三科會**太多、令人難以承受**。」

too much = 某種數量、壓力或負擔超過合理承受範圍

11. **so much + uncountable noun (大量 / 這麼多) — 這麼多 ; 如此多**

Practice 22

> “Why is there **so much homework**?”

「為甚麼有**這麼多功課**？」

Practice 23

> “He gave us **so much useful advice**.”

「他給了我們**這麼多有用的建議**。」

so much + uncountable noun = 強調不可數事物的數量非常大

12. **so much = to such a great degree — 如此 ; 非常**

Practice 24

> “I learned **so much** from that teacher.”

「我從那位老師身上學到了**很多很多 / 非常多**。」

Practice 25

> “His teaching style changed me ****so much****.”

「他的教學方式對我的改變****非常大****。」

****so much** = 某個行為、感受或影響達到很高程度******

13. ****as much + uncountable noun (同等數量) — 一樣多****

Practice 26

> “I don’t have ****as much time**** as I used to.”

「我沒有以前****那麼多時間****。」

Practice 27

> “She did ****as much work as**** the rest of the group.”

「她完成的工作量跟組內其他人****一樣多****。」

****as much...as** = 表示兩者在不可數數量 / 程度上相等******

14. ****as much as + amount/number (多達) — 多達；竟有.....之多****

Practice 28

> “Some students study for ****as much as five hours**** a day.”

「有些學生每天讀書****多達五小時****。」

Practice 29

> “The project may cost ****as much as a million dollars****.”

「這個項目的成本可能****高達一百萬元****。」

****as much as + amount** = 強調某個數量大得值得注意******

15. ****as much as = although / despite the fact that (讓步) — 雖然；儘管****

A genuinely useful formal/conversational construction.

Practice 30

> “**As much as** I respected him, I did not agree with everything he said.”

「**雖然**我很尊重他，但我並不同意他說的每一件事。」

Practice 31

> “As much as I enjoy history, I also like science.”

「**儘管**我很喜歡歷史，我也喜歡科學。」

as much as + clause = 承認某個強烈事實 / 感受，同時指出另一個不同或相反的事實

This is more advanced.

16. **much of + noun/pronoun (某事物的大部分) — 大部分；很多**

Practice 32

> “Much of the lesson was discussion.”

「那堂課的**大部分時間 / 內容**都是討論。」

Practice 33

> “I remember **much of what he taught us**.”

「我仍記得他教我們的**很多內容**。」

much of + determiner/pronoun = 某個已指定不可數整體中的很大部分

Common:

* much of the work

* much of my time

* much of what...

* much of it

17. **not much of a + noun (不算是很好的.....) — 不太算.....；不是很出色的.....**

A very useful conversational construction.

Practice 34

> “He wasn’t ****much of a speaker**** at first.”

「起初他****不算是很出色的演講者****。」

Practice 35

> “I’m not ****much of a history expert****.”

「我****不算甚麼歷史專家 / 對歷史不算很在行****。」

****not much of a + noun = 表示某人在某身分、能力或類型方面並不突出 / 不太符合****

Very common conversationally.

18. ****much the same (非常相似) — 大致相同 ; 幾乎一樣****

Practice 36

> “The two teaching methods are ****much the same****.”

「這兩種教學方法****大致相同 / 幾乎一樣****。」

Practice 37

> “His attitude remained much the same over the years.”

「多年來，他的態度一直****大致沒有改變****。」

****much the same = 在大部分重要方面相同，差異很小****

Here ****much**** strengthens the idea of similarity.

19. ****much better/worse/easier/etc. (大幅比較) — 好得多 / 差得多 / 容易得多****

This belongs to the same comparative-intensifier sense as your original sentence, but it is worth consolidating.

Practice 38

> “I understand history ****much better**** now.”

「我現在對歷史****理解得好多了****。」

Practice 39

> “The second exam was ****much easier****.”

「第二次考試****容易得多****。」

****much + comparative = 比較差距顯著****

This is one of the most important uses of ****much**** in affirmative sentences.

20. ****much less + noun/adjective/verb (更不用說；更不可能) — 更別說；更不用說****

A very useful formal/logical expression.

Practice 40

> “He could barely remember the date, ****much less explain the event****.”

「他連日期都幾乎記不起來，****更不用說解釋那件事了****。」

Practice 41

> “I don’t have time to read one book, ****much less five****.”

「我連一本書都沒時間讀，****更不用說五本了****。」

****much less = 如果前面較容易 / 較少要求的事情都做不到，後面更困難 / 更多要求的事情就更不用說****

Especially common in formal writing.

21. ****much to + someone’s emotion (結果令人非常……) — 令某人非常……的是****

A useful formal construction.

Practice 42

> “**Much to my surprise**, he remembered my name.”

「**令我非常驚訝的是**，他竟然記得我的名字。」

Practice 43

> “Much to everyone’s relief, the exam was postponed.”

「**令大家大大鬆一口氣的是**，考試延期了。」

much to someone’s surprise/delight/relief = 某件事情在很大程度上引起該人的某種情緒

Common:

* much to my surprise

* much to her delight

* much to our relief

* much to his disappointment

22. **very much so = definitely / strongly true — 的確如此；非常是**

A useful conversational response.

Practice 44

> “Was he an influential teacher?”

> “**Very much so.**”

「他是一位很有影響力的老師嗎？」

「**的確如此 / 非常是。**」

Practice 45

> “Are students still interested in the subject?”

> “Very much so.”

「學生仍然對這科有興趣嗎？」

「**非常有 / 的確如此。**」

very much so = 強烈確認前面所問 / 所述的情況確實成立

23. **much as + clause (雖然 ; 儘管) — 儘管 ; 雖然**

Closely related to **as much as** in concessive use, but more formal.

Practice 46

> “**Much as** I admired him, I knew he was not perfect.”

「**儘管**我很欣賞他，我也知道他並不完美。」

Practice 47

> “Much as she wanted to stay, she had to leave.”

「**雖然**她很想留下，但她必須離開。」

much as = despite the fact that ; 儘管某種感受 / 情況非常強烈

Register: formal/literary.

24. **so much for + idea/plan (表示某事失敗 / 不成立) —就到此為止 ; 看來.....泡湯了**

A common idiomatic expression worth flagging.

Practice 48

> “**So much for** our plan to finish early.”

「我們原本想提早完成——看來這個計劃**泡湯了**。」

Practice 49

> “So much for the idea that the test would be easy.”

「看來『這次測驗會很容易』這個想法**完全不成立了**。」

so much for X = 表示 X 已失敗、被證明不成立，或不再值得期待

This is idiomatic; it should not be interpreted literally as quantity.

Important distinction: **much vs many**

This is essential.

much

with uncountable nouns:

- > much time
- > much information
- > much work

many

with plural countable nouns:

- > many students
- > many questions
- > many books

So:

- > **much information** ✓
- > **many facts** ✓

Not:

- > *many information* ✗
- > *much students* ✗

Important distinction: **much vs more**

You just curated **more**.

much

= a large amount / degree

- > "I don't have much time."

「我沒有很多時間。」

more

= a greater/additional amount

> “I need more time.”

「我需要更多時間。」

And:

> **much more time**

= **多很多時間 / 更多得多**

So **much** can itself modify **more**.

That is exactly what happens in:

> **much more lively**

Important distinction: **much** vs **most**

The irregular scale:

> much → more → most

For uncountable quantity:

> much time

> more time

> the most time

Likewise:

> many → more → most

for countable nouns.

So **more/most** serve both **much** and **many**.

Important distinction: **much** vs **a lot of**

In affirmative everyday English:

Less natural:

> “I have much work today.”

More natural:

> “I have a lot of work today.”

But **much** is very natural in:

Negatives

> “I don’t have much work.”

Questions

> “Do you have much work?”

Formal writing

> “Much research has been conducted.”

So register matters.

Important distinction: **much** vs **very**

This is crucial.

very

normally modifies base adjectives/adverbs:

> very lively

> very clearly

much

normally modifies comparatives:

> much livelier

> much more clearly

So:

> **very lively** ✓

> **much livelier** ✓

> **very much livelier** usually awkward

> **much lively** ❌

Important distinction: **very much** vs **much**

Affirmative verb:

> “I **very much** admire him.”

very natural.

Bare:

> “I much admire him.”

possible, but formal/literary.

Negative:

> “I don’t much like it.”

very natural.

So word position and sentence type matter.

Important distinction: **much more** vs **very much**

much more

usually comparison:

> “The second class was much more interesting.”

「第二堂課有趣得多。」

very much

usually degree of a verb/state:

> “I very much enjoyed the class.”

「我非常享受那堂課。」

Do not interchange them.

Important distinction: **too much vs so much**

too much

= more than acceptable

> “There is too much homework.”

「功課太多。」

so much

= very large amount, without automatically saying it is unacceptable

> “There is so much homework!”

「竟然有這麼多功課！」

Same contrast as **too many vs so many**.

Important distinction: **much of vs many of**

much of

with uncountable/singular mass content:

> much of the work

many of

with plural countable items:

> many of the students

Both mean a large portion, but noun type differs.

Important distinction: **not much vs not very**

not much

usually quantity:

> “There isn’t much time.”

「時間不多。」

not very

usually degree:

> “The lesson isn’t very long.”

「那堂課不是很長。」

They operate differently.

Important distinction: **much better vs very good**

very good

absolute degree:

> 很好

much better

comparison:

> 好得多

> “His first lesson was very good.”

「他的第一堂課很好。」

> “His second lesson was much better.”

「他的第二堂課好得多。」

Family-extension sweep

Much has essentially no derivational family. Its useful modern network consists of grammatical constructions:

- * **much + comparative** =得多
- * **much + uncountable noun** = 很多 / 大量
- * **much — pronoun** = 很多
- * **much + verb** = 很 / 在很大程度上
- * **very much + verb** = 非常
- * **not much** = 不多 / 沒多少
- * **how much** = 多少 ; 多少錢
- * **too much** = 太多 / 過量
- * **so much** = 這麼多 / 非常多
- * **as much...as** = 一樣多
- * **as much as + amount** = 多達
- * **as much as + clause** = 雖然 / 儘管
- * **much of** =的大部分
- * **not much of a...** = 不太算很好的 / 不怎麼是.....
- * **much the same** = 大致相同
- * **much less** = 更不用說
- * **much to someone's surprise/etc.** = 令某人非常.....
- * **very much so** = 的確如此
- * **much as** = 儘管
- * **so much for...** = 看來.....失敗 / 不成立了
- * **more / most** = much 的比較 / 最高級對應形式

There is no need to invent morphological relatives; **much** is primarily a grammar-rich word.

Master comparison

Form / function	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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much + comparative	強調兩者比較差距很大 ;得多
much + uncountable noun	表示不可數事物具有大量 / 某一數量
much — pronoun	代替已知不可數內容，表示很大的數量 / 部分
much + verb	表示某個行為、感受或變化達到很高程度
very much + verb	強烈加深喜歡、感謝、希望、欣賞等程度
not much	某種不可數數量 / 程度很少 ; 沒有多少
how much	詢問不可數數量、程度或價格
too much	不可數數量 / 負擔超過合理或可接受範圍
so much	強調不可數事物的數量 / 程度非常大
as much...as	兩者在不可數數量 / 程度上相等
as much as + amount	強調數量大得值得注意 ; 多達
as much as + clause	承認一個強烈事實，但另一個不同結果仍成立 ; 雖然

much of	某個已指定整體中的很大部分	
not much of a...	某人在某身分、能力或類型方面不太突出	
much the same	在大部分重要方面相同，只有很小差異	
much less	前一較容易事項尚且不能成立，後一更難事項更不用說	
much to someone's surprise/etc.	某事在很大程度上引起某人的特定情緒	
very much so	強烈確認前述情況確實成立	
much as	正式地表示「儘管 / 雖然」	
so much for...	表示某個想法、計劃或期望已失敗 / 被證明不成立	

For your original sentence

> “Once he started teaching, he became **much more lively than people expected**.”

The exact meaning is:

much = 用來加強比較級 more lively，表示實際活潑、生動的程度與大家的預期相比有很大的差距

So:

> **much more lively**

= **「生動活潑得多」**

Natural translation:

> **「不過，一旦他開始上課，他就比大家想像中生動得多。」**

The key grammar contrast to lock in is:

> **very lively** → 非常生動

> **more lively** → 更生動

> **much more lively** → 生動得多 / 更加生動很多

That is exactly the job **much** is doing in your passage.